Palestine, Israel and Gaza

48 key historical facts stated in Jeff Kisling's blog posts on this topic, each checked against an outside source.

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Posts on this topic, concentrated between October 2023 and mid-2025, follow the Gaza war and its background: the 1948 Nakba, the 1967 occupation and the blockade of Gaza since 2007, casualty figures reported by the Gaza Health Ministry and UN agencies, famine warnings, the ICJ and ICC proceedings, UN votes and ceasefires, and U.S. military aid. They also document Quaker responses (AFSC and FCNL), arms-embargo and solidarity campaigns, aid flotillas, and the killing of journalists, aid workers and individual Palestinians whose stories became widely known.

48 facts checked against outside sources, 5 of them corrected (the posts had a detail slightly wrong; the corrected version is shown). Each fact lists the source that confirms it and the posts that state it. The wording is a plain summary, not a quotation from the posts.

Facts

1. 1948

In the 1948 Nakba ('catastrophe'), roughly 700,000 to 750,000 Palestinians fled or were expelled from the land that became Israel; Palestinians mark Nakba Day on May 15, the day after Israel's declaration of independence.

- **Source:** Commemoration of the 75th anniversary of the Nakba at UN Headquarters in New York (United Nations (UNISPAL)); Nakba (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Nakba and the Middle East today (2024-06-16); Nakba and colonialism in the US (2024-06-20); Ongoing Nakba (2025-05-17); The Modern Face of Empire (2025-06-20)

2. 1948–1949

The American Friends Service Committee began working with people displaced by the 1948 war at the request of the United Nations, and in 1949 organized relief for Palestinian refugees in the Gaza Strip; AFSC describes itself as supporting humanitarian efforts in Gaza since 1948.

- **Source:** Middle East Region (American Friends Service Committee); New York Times rejects Quaker ad for calling Israel's actions 'genocide' (American Friends Service Committee)
- **In the posts:** New York Times blocks AFSC (2025-01-09)

3. 1949-12-08

UNRWA, the UN agency for Palestine refugees, was created by UN General Assembly Resolution 302 (IV) on December 8, 1949, and began operations on May 1, 1950.

- **Source:** Who We Are (UNRWA)
- **In the posts:** International Day of Peace (2024-09-22)

4. 1967-06

In the Six-Day War of June 5–10, 1967, Israel captured the West Bank including East Jerusalem (from Jordan), the Gaza Strip and Sinai (from Egypt), and the Golan Heights (from Syria); the West Bank, East Jerusalem and Gaza have been under Israeli occupation since.

- **Source:** Six-Day War (Encyclopaedia Britannica); Six-Day War (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Time for America to recognize Palestine (2025-02-07); Last Chapter of Genocide (2025-03-24); Masafer Yatta and Center for Jewish Nonviolence (2025-04-24)

5. 2007-06

Israel imposed a land, sea and air blockade on the Gaza Strip in June 2007, after Hamas took control of Gaza, citing security concerns.

- **Source:** Gaza Blockade (UN OCHA occupied Palestinian territory); Madleen: Israel warns it will stop aid yacht reaching Gaza (BBC News)
- **In the posts:** Freedom Flotilla Madleen updates (2025-06-06); Madleen Stopped by Israel (2025-06-09)

6. 2010-05-31

On May 31, 2010, Israeli forces raided the Gaza-bound flotilla ship Mavi Marmara; nine activists were killed during the raid and a tenth died in 2014 after years in a coma.

- **Source:** Gaza flotilla raid (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Humanitarian Aid Ship Attacked (2025-05-03); All part of the same genocide (2025-05-04)

7. 2014

In 2014 the ICC Prosecutor found a reasonable basis to believe war crimes were committed during the 2010 Gaza flotilla (Mavi Marmara) raid but declined to open an investigation because the potential cases were not of sufficient gravity.

- **Source:** Judges ask prosecutor to reconsider Gaza flotilla decision – What you should know (Coalition for the International Criminal Court)
- **In the posts:** All part of the same genocide (2025-05-04)

8. 2019–2028

Under a 10-year memorandum of understanding covering 2019–2028, the United States provides Israel $3.8 billion a year in military aid ($3.3 billion in Foreign Military Financing plus $500 million for missile defense).

- **Source:** U.S. Security Cooperation with Israel (U.S. Department of State); Israel–United States military relations (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** A time of dark shame (2024-08-22)

9. 2022-05-04

On May 4, 2022 Israel's Supreme Court rejected a petition against evictions in Masafer Yatta, allowing the military to remove residents from parts of the area declared Firing Zone 918; roughly 1,000–1,200 Palestinian residents were at risk of expulsion.

> ***Note:*** *The posts' description of this as potentially the largest forced transfer in the West Bank since 1967 was not stated in the sources seen.*

- **Source:** Firing Zone 918 (Wikipedia); Israel's Supreme Court ruling permits eviction of 1,000 Palestinians in West Bank (SabrangIndia)
- **In the posts:** Masafer Yatta and Center for Jewish Nonviolence (2025-04-24)

10. 2023-10

The Friends Committee on National Legislation (FCNL) stated that it condemns Hamas' attacks and treatment of civilians, calls for the release of all hostages, condemns Israel's indiscriminate bombing of Gaza, and urges lawmakers to push for a permanent ceasefire.

- **Source:** The War in Israel-Palestine (Friends Committee on National Legislation)
- **In the posts:** FCNL's "Calling for a Ceasefire: Israel-Palestine Briefing" (2023-10-26); Friends Committee on National Legislation (2024-01-04); Coalition Demanding Immediate Halt to U.S. Weapons Fueling Gaza War (2024-09-07)

11. 2023-10-07

In the Hamas-led attack on Israel on October 7, 2023, about 1,200 people were killed (most of them civilians) and about 250 people were taken hostage into Gaza.

- **Source:** October 7 attacks (Wikipedia); Gaza ceasefire's future unclear as Hamas frees last 6 living hostages under 1st phase of its deal with Israel (PBS NewsHour / AP)
- **In the posts:** Possible ceasefire (2025-01-17); Israel’s Bombs Rained Down at 2 am (2025-03-19); Joint Task Force October 7 (2025-03-28)

12. 2023-10-18

On October 18, 2023, the United States vetoed a Brazilian-led UN Security Council draft resolution that called for 'humanitarian pauses' in Gaza.

- **Source:** Israel-Gaza crisis: US vetoes Security Council resolution (UN News)
- **In the posts:** Solidarity with Palestine (2023-10-28)

13. 2023-12-06

Palestinian poet and professor Refaat Alareer, author of the poem 'If I Must Die,' was killed in an Israeli airstrike in northern Gaza on December 6, 2023.

- **Source:** Refaat Alareer (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** If I Must Die, Let It Bring Hope (2024-10-08); This is what it means to be from Gaza (2024-11-09); Neither of them had to die (2025-02-27)

14. 2023-12-29

South Africa filed a case against Israel at the International Court of Justice on December 29, 2023, under the Genocide Convention; the Court issued provisional measures orders on January 26, March 28 and May 24, 2024.

- **Source:** Application of the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide in the Gaza Strip (South Africa v. Israel) (International Court of Justice)
- **In the posts:** The greatest moral crime of our time (2024-10-09); Unfit for human survival (2024-11-14); The Hague Group (2025-02-01); Expanding IDF Incursion into Gaza (2025-05-26)

15. 2024-01-26 (corrected)

In its January 26, 2024 provisional measures order, the ICJ found that the rights of Palestinians in Gaza to protection from acts of genocide were plausible and ordered Israel to take measures to prevent genocidal acts; it

did not rule on whether Israel is committing genocide. Former ICJ President Joan Donoghue later stressed that the Court had not found it plausible that Israel was committing genocide.

> ***Correction:*** *Posts (and an AFSC statement they quote) describe the ruling as finding Israel's actions 'plausibly genocidal' or that it is 'plausible' Israel is committing genocide; the Court's plausibility test applied to the rights asserted by South Africa.*

- **Source:** South Africa's genocide case against Israel (Wikipedia); South Africa v. Israel case page (International Court of Justice)
- **In the posts:** The eyes of the children are looking at us now (2024-10-23); New York Times blocks AFSC (2025-01-09)

16. 2024-01-26

The United States paused funding to UNRWA in late January 2024 after Israel alleged that twelve UNRWA employees took part in the October 7 attack.

- **Source:** UNRWA and Israel (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Aid, Not Arms: Opening the Way to Peace in the Middle East (2025-01-11)

17. 2024-01-29 (corrected)

Hind Rajab, a five-year-old Palestinian girl, was killed in Gaza City on January 29, 2024, along with six relatives in the car and two Palestine Red Crescent paramedics sent to rescue her; her recorded calls for help drew worldwide attention.

> ***Correction:*** *One post calls her six years old; she was five (born May 3, 2018), though many early reports said six. Another post correctly says five.*

- **Source:** Killing of Hind Rajab (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** BREAKING: DHS enters Columbia dorms (2025-03-14); Pro-Palestinian solidarity Spring 2025 (2025-04-26)

18. 2024-02

The Senate's February 2024 national security supplemental appropriations bill included $14.1 billion in funding for Israel.

> ***Note:*** *The House had separately passed a $14.3 billion Israel aid bill (H.R. 6126) on November 2, 2023.*

- **Source:** The Senate's Security Supplemental Budget Bill: Key Provisions (The Heritage Foundation); House votes for $14.3 billion in Israeli aid, bypasses White House coupling Israel, Ukraine (The American Israelite)
- **In the posts:** A time of dark shame (2024-08-22)

19. 2024-04-16

In April 2024, UN Women reported that six months into the war more than 10,000 Palestinian women had been killed in Gaza, among them an estimated 6,000 mothers, leaving 19,000 children orphaned.

- **Source:** Six months into the war on Gaza, over 10,000 women have been killed, among them an estimated 6,000 mothers, leaving 19,000 children orphaned (UN Women)
- **In the posts:** Questions from Palestinian Children in Gaza (2025-01-23)

20. 2024-07-19

On July 19, 2024, the ICJ issued an advisory opinion declaring Israel's continued presence in the Occupied Palestinian Territory unlawful and saying it should be brought to an end.

- **Source:** Legal Consequences arising from the Policies and Practices of Israel in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including East Jerusalem (International Court of Justice); UN General Assembly demands Israel end 'unlawful presence' in Occupied Palestinian Territory (UN News)
- **In the posts:** Summer School (2024-09-06); UN demands Israel end ‘unlawful presence’ (2024-09-19); Unfit for human survival (2024-11-14)

21. 2024-08-22

As of August 22, 2024, the Gaza Ministry of Health reported at least 40,265 Palestinians killed and 93,144 injured since October 7, 2023 (as relayed by UN OCHA).

- **Source:** Humanitarian Situation Update #208 | Gaza Strip (UN OCHA occupied Palestinian territory)
- **In the posts:** Stop dropping 2000-pound bombs (2024-08-24); unflinching (2024-08-28); Joint Resolutions of Disapproval (2024-11-21)

22. 2024-09-05

In September 2024 FCNL joined a coalition letter urging the Biden administration to immediately halt U.S. arms transfers to Israel because of civilian harm in Gaza.

- **Source:** FCNL Joins Coalition Demanding Immediate Halt to U.S. Weapons Fueling Gaza War (Friends Committee on National Legislation)
- **In the posts:** Coalition Demanding Immediate Halt to U.S. Weapons Fueling Gaza War (2024-09-07)

23. 2024-09-18

On September 18, 2024, the UN General Assembly adopted a resolution, by 124 votes to 14 with 43 abstentions, demanding that Israel end its 'unlawful presence' in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, following the ICJ advisory opinion.

- **Source:** UN General Assembly demands Israel end 'unlawful presence' in Occupied Palestinian Territory (UN News)
- **In the posts:** UN demands Israel end ‘unlawful presence’ (2024-09-19)

24. 2024-10

In October 2024 Israel's Knesset passed laws banning UNRWA from operating in Israel.

- **Source:** UNRWA and Israel (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Unfit for human survival (2024-11-14); Stop Famine in Gaza (2025-03-09)

25. 2024-10-07

Brown University's Costs of War project calculated that the U.S. approved $17.9 billion in security assistance for Israel's military operations between October 7, 2023 and September 30, 2024 (Senator Sanders cited a figure of about $18 billion).

- **Source:** United States Spending on Israel's Military Operations and Related U.S. Operations in the Region, October 7, 2023 – September 30, 2024 (Costs of War, Watson Institute, Brown University); Senate rejects effort to block arms sales to Israel (Mondoweiss)
- **In the posts:** Sanders, Warren and arms embargo to Israel (2024-11-15)

26. 2024-10-13

On October 13, 2024 Secretary of State Antony Blinken and Defense Secretary Lloyd Austin wrote to Israeli officials demanding steps within 30 days to improve humanitarian access to Gaza, warning of possible implications for U.S. policy on military assistance.

- **Source:** Full text of US letter to Israel: Let aid into Gaza or face consequences (Al Majalla)
- **In the posts:** Don’t encourage war (2024-11-13)

27. 2024-10-29

As of October 29, 2024, the Gaza Ministry of Health reported at least 43,061 Palestinians killed and 101,223 injured since October 7, 2023 (as relayed by UN OCHA).

- **Source:** Humanitarian Situation Update #233 | Gaza Strip (UN OCHA occupied Palestinian territory)
- **In the posts:** Sanders, Warren and arms embargo to Israel (2024-11-15); Refusing Complicity in Israel's Literary Institutions (2024-12-06)

28. 2024-11-20

On November 20, 2024, the U.S. Senate rejected Senator Bernie Sanders' joint resolutions of disapproval to block certain arms sales to Israel; 18 senators voted in favor.

- **Source:** Senate rejects effort to block arms sales to Israel (Mondoweiss)
- **In the posts:** Don't encourage war (2024-11-13); Sanders, Warren and arms embargo to Israel (2024-11-15); Joint Resolutions of Disapproval (2024-11-21)

29. 2024-11-20

On November 20, 2024, the United States vetoed a UN Security Council draft resolution demanding an immediate and unconditional ceasefire in Gaza.

- **Source:** United States vetoes Gaza ceasefire resolution at Security Council (UN News)
- **In the posts:** Joint Resolutions of Disapproval (2024-11-21)

30. 2024-11-21 (corrected)

On November 21, 2024, ICC Pre-Trial Chamber I issued arrest warrants for Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and former Defence Minister Yoav Gallant for the war crime of starvation as a method of warfare and the crimes against humanity of murder, persecution and other inhumane acts.

> ***Correction:*** *One post lists 'extermination' among the charges; the Chamber said the elements of extermination were not established and instead found reasonable grounds for murder.*

- **Source:** Situation in the State of Palestine: ICC Pre-Trial Chamber I rejects the State of Israel's challenges to jurisdiction and issues warrants of arrest for Benjamin Netanyahu and Yoav Gallant (International Criminal Court)
- **In the posts:** Joint Resolutions of Disapproval (2024-11-21); Restoring International Order (2025-03-06); Intentionally Starving Palestinians (2025-05-28)

31. 2024-12-05

In early December 2024 Amnesty International published a report concluding that Israel has committed and is continuing to commit genocide against Palestinians in Gaza.

> ***Note:*** *Amnesty USA's page dates the report December 4, 2024 (U.S. time); the posts give December 5, 2024, the international release date.*

- **Source:** 'You Feel Like You Are Subhuman': Israel's Genocide Against Palestinians in Gaza (Amnesty International USA)
- **In the posts:** Keep our spirits and souls intact (2024-12-14); All part of the same genocide (2025-05-04)

32. 2025-01-08

In January 2025 AFSC said The New York Times had rejected its advertisement because it called Israel's actions genocide; AFSC said its staff in Gaza had provided 1.5 million meals and other aid units since October 2023.

- **Source:** New York Times rejects Quaker ad for calling Israel's actions 'genocide' (American Friends Service Committee)
- **In the posts:** New York Times blocks AFSC (2025-01-09)

33. 2025-01-19

A ceasefire between Israel and Hamas took effect on January 19, 2025; Israel halted the entry of all aid into Gaza on March 2, 2025 and resumed large-scale strikes on March 18, 2025, ending the truce.

> ***Note:*** *One post gives the blockade start as March 1 and the return to war as March 17 (late-night U.S. time); other posts give March 2 and March 18.*

- **Source:** January 2025 Gaza war ceasefire (Wikipedia); Gaza Can't Wait: Lift the Blockade Now! (Friends Committee on National Legislation)
- **In the posts:** Two Demonstrations (2025-04-06); All part of the same genocide (2025-05-04); ‘We cannot remain silent’ (2025-05-13)

34. 2025-01-31 (corrected)

The Hague Group was founded in The Hague on January 31, 2025 by nine states — Belize, Bolivia, Colombia, Cuba, Honduras, Malaysia, Namibia, Senegal and South Africa — pledging to uphold ICJ and ICC rulings on Palestine.

> ***Correction:*** *A post lists Chile among the nine founding members; the founding members included Cuba, not Chile.*

- **Source:** The Hague Group (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** The Hague Group (2025-02-01); Restoring International Order (2025-03-06)

35. 2025-02-22

By late February 2025 the Gaza Health Ministry reported that more than 48,000 Palestinians had been killed in Gaza; the ministry does not distinguish civilians from combatants (as reported by AP).

- **Source:** Gaza ceasefire's future unclear as Hamas frees last 6 living hostages under 1st phase of its deal with Israel (PBS NewsHour / AP)
- **In the posts:** Israel’s Bombs Rained Down at 2 am (2025-03-19)

36. 2025-03-02

The documentary 'No Other Land,' directed by Basel Adra, Hamdan Ballal, Yuval Abraham and Rachel Szor, won the Academy Award for Best Documentary Feature on March 2, 2025.

- **Source:** No Other Land (Wikipedia)
- **In the posts:** Oscars and Palestine (2025-03-03); ‘No Other Land’ devastation continues (2025-03-04); ‘No Other Land’ viewing (2025-03-05)

37. 2025-03-18

Israel's surprise strikes on Gaza in the early hours of March 18, 2025 killed more than 400 people, according to Gaza health officials, ending the January ceasefire.

- **Source:** Massacre at 2 A.M.: Israel Resumes Indiscriminate Attacks Against Gaza, Killing Over 400 People (Drop Site News)
- **In the posts:** Hanging between heaven and earth (2025-03-18); Israel’s Bombs Rained Down at 2 am (2025-03-19)

38. 2025-03-23

On March 23, 2025, Israeli forces killed 15 emergency and aid workers — from the Palestine Red Crescent Society, Gaza Civil Defence and the UN — near Rafah and buried them with their vehicles in a mass grave; a video from a paramedic's phone contradicted the army's initial account.

- **Source:** Rafah paramedic massacre (Wikipedia)

- **In the posts:** 15 first responders killed (2025-03-31); Gianluca Costantini (2025-04-09)

39. 2025-03-24

Palestinian journalist Hossam Shabat was killed when an Israeli strike hit his car in Beit Lahia, northern Gaza, on March 24, 2025.

- **Source:** Hossam Shabat's Last Article (Drop Site News)
- **In the posts:** Israel Kills Journalist Hossam Shabat (2025-03-25); You knew they were going to kill you (2025-05-14)

40. 2025-04-07

A joint statement by UN agency heads on April 7, 2025 said at least 408 humanitarian workers, including more than 280 UNRWA staff, had been killed in Gaza since October 2023.

- **Source:** Joint UN statement: World must act with urgency to save Palestinians in Gaza (UNOPS)
- **In the posts:** War of Extermination (2025-04-08)

41. 2025-05 (corrected)

In mid-2025 Israel's defence minister was Israel Katz; Yoav Gallant, named in the ICC warrant, had held the post earlier in the war.

> ***Correction:*** *A May 26, 2025 post attributes a new three-stage war plan to 'Israeli Defense Minister Yoav Gallant'; by then the defence minister was Israel Katz.*

- **Source:** Madleen: Israel warns it will stop aid yacht reaching Gaza (BBC News); ICC issues warrants of arrest for Benjamin Netanyahu and Yoav Gallant (International Criminal Court)
- **In the posts:** Expanding IDF Incursion into Gaza (2025-05-26)

42. 2025-05-02

On May 2, 2025, the Freedom Flotilla Coalition aid ship Conscience was struck by two drones in international waters off Malta while preparing to sail for Gaza.

- **Source:** Drones hit 'Freedom Flotilla' Gaza aid ship in international waters (Al Jazeera)
- **In the posts:** Humanitarian Aid Ship Attacked (2025-05-03); Madleen Stopped by Israel (2025-06-09)

43. 2025-05-12

An Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) analysis released May 12, 2025 placed all of Gaza in Emergency (Phase 4), with about 244,000 people in Catastrophe (Phase 5), and projected about half a million people (one in five) facing starvation, warning of a critical risk of famine.

- **Source:** 'Children Are Being Starved By Design': All of Gaza Faces Hunger Crisis Due to Israeli Siege (Common Dreams)
- **In the posts:** ‘We cannot remain silent’ (2025-05-13); Critical famine risk (2025-05-19); Hunger Strikes (2025-05-22); Intentionally Starving Palestinians (2025-05-28)

44. 2025-05-13

Palestinian journalist Hassan Eslaiah was killed in an Israeli strike on the burns unit of Nasser Hospital, where he was being treated, in mid-May 2025.

- **Source:** Goodbye, Hassan. You knew they were going to kill you. (Mondoweiss)
- **In the posts:** You knew they were going to kill you (2025-05-14)

45. 2025-06-04

As of June 4, 2025, the Gaza Ministry of Health reported at least 54,607 Palestinians killed and 125,341 injured since October 7, 2023, including 4,335 killed since hostilities resumed on March 18, 2025 (as relayed by UN OCHA).

- **Source:** Humanitarian Situation Update #294 | Gaza Strip (UN OCHA occupied Palestinian territory)
- **In the posts:** Freedom Flotilla Madleen updates (2025-06-06); Break the Cycle of Death (2025-06-07)

46. 2025-06-09

In June 2025 Israeli forces intercepted the Freedom Flotilla yacht Madleen, which was trying to reach Gaza with aid, and detained its 12-person crew, including climate activist Greta Thunberg.

- **Source:** Madleen: Israel warns it will stop aid yacht reaching Gaza (BBC News); Madleen Gaza flotilla updates: Israel detains Greta Thunberg, 11 activists (Al Jazeera)
- **In the posts:** Freedom Flotilla Madleen updates (2025-06-06); Madleen update 6.8.2025 (2025-06-08); Madleen Stopped by Israel (2025-06-09)

47. 2026-09

In September 2026 Macklemore was dropped from Ed Sheeran's U.S. Loop Tour after calling for 'Free Palestine' while performing 'Hind's Hall' at MetLife Stadium shows on September 4 and 5.

> ***Note:*** *Posts mention the September 5 show; the source says the remarks were made on September 4 and 5.*

- **Source:** Macklemore dropped from Ed Sheeran tour after 'Free Palestine' remarks (Khaleej Times)
- **In the posts:** Quakers and the Macklemore-Sheeran controversy (2026-09-21)

48. Undated

Israel's West Bank separation barrier has a planned route of about 712 km, and about 85% of it runs inside the occupied West Bank rather than along the 1967 Green Line, according to B'Tselem.

> ***Note:*** *The post gives 708 km, an earlier published figure for the route; B'Tselem currently gives 712 km.*

- **Source:** The Separation Barrier (B'Tselem)
- **In the posts:** Palestinian street art (2025-05-11)

Not yet verified

These statements appear in the posts but could not be checked against an outside source during this pass. They are not confirmed and not shown to be wrong.

- Iowa Yearly Meeting (Conservative) approved a minute supporting the Boycott, Divestment and Sanctions (BDS) movement in July 2015. In the posts: Peace and Socials Concerns, Iowa Yearly Meeting (Conservative) 2015; Queries related to peace and nonviolence
- Counts of journalists killed in Gaza (e.g., from the Committee to Protect Journalists) referenced as 'hundreds' in the posts. In the posts: ‘We cannot remain silent’